MINUTES OF THE
CITY OF HOLLADAY
CITY COUNCIL MEETING

Thursday, April 17, 2025
5:30pm
City Council Chambers
4580 South 2300 East
Holladay, Utah

Briefing Session 5:30 pm

ATTENDANCE:

Mayor Rob Dahle
Paul Fotheringham
Emily Gray
Matt Durham
Ty Brewer
Drew Quinn

City Staff:
Gina Chamness, City Manager
Jayme Blakesley, City Attorney
Stephanie Carlson, City Recorder

Ahead of the City Council Meeting, the agenda items were discussed. Mayor Rob Dahle noted that there will likely be members of the public present to share comments about the district split initiative. He wants to allow people to make their comments but does not want to have a discussion about the matter during the public comment period. He will make a statement before the public comment period opens to let everyone know that there is an awareness of the issue.

Mayor Dahle was willing to meet with residents to discuss the district split initiative. He pointed out that there is not enough time for this to be on the ballot this November. Mayor Dahle wanted to be respectful to the residents and make sure everyone is heard. At the same time, it needs to be made clear that there will not be a back-and-forth conversation during the public comment period. Council Members Brewer & Quinn expressed a willingness to sit in on a future meeting with residents to discuss the issue.

The City Council Meeting agenda items were reviewed. Mayor Dahle reviewed the calendar items. He referenced the City Council Meetings scheduled for May 1, 8, and 15, 2025, and June 5 and 12, 2025. There is also the Arbor Day event, Tree Giveaway, and Community Pancake Breakfast.

MINUTES OF THE
CITY OF HOLLADAY
CITY COUNCIL MEETING

Thursday, April 17, 2025
6:00 p.m.
City Council Chambers
4580 South 2300 East
Holladay, Utah

ATTENDANCE:

Mayor Rob Dahle
Paul Fotheringham
Emily Gray
Matt Durham
Ty Brewer
Drew Quinn

City Staff:
Gina Chamness, City Manager
Jayme Blakesley, City Attorney
Stephanie Carlson, City Recorder

I. ***Welcome*** – Mayor Rob Dahle.
Mayor Dahle called the City Council Meeting to order at approximately 6:00 p.m.

II. ***Pledge of Allegiance.***
Mayor Dahle led the Pledge of Allegiance.

III. ***Public Comments.***
Mayor Dahle opened the public comment period. He explained that when comments are shared, the City Council is able to listen to those comments from members of the community. However, there is not typically a back-and-forth discussion. Some emails have been received about the district split initiative, so there is familiarity with the subject matter some of the public comments will address. Mayor Dahle has received five or six emails about this and the issues are best summarized in an email from Jed and Betsy VanDenBerghe. That email had a lot of information and it has been reviewed by the City Council. Mayor Dahle expressed a willingness to meet with residents to discuss this issue.

Trudy Jorgensen-Price shared updates about the library. She reported that tax season is over and with the assistance of the library staff booking the appointments and the AARP tax volunteers, there were almost 750 tax appointments. 42 people were moved off of the waitlist and there were only 22 people who were unable to be assisted. She reported that the Seed Library is still open. This month, an extra Storytime event has been added, so there is Storytime on Monday and Tuesday mornings. From May through July, the Storytime event on Monday will take place at the gazebo in the park. Ms. Jorgensen-Price reported that on April 26, 2025, there will be a collaboration with Clark Planetarium.

Jason Brand - 2251 Melodie Ann Way. He spoke to the City Council last year about fireworks and it is that time of year again. The Utah State Law allows for firework restrictions based on

hazardous conditions and not based on residents who do not like fireworks. Mr. Brand likes fireworks on certain holidays and so do his children. He asked that this be taken into consideration.

David Stephenson – 2555 Melony Dr and also spoke to the City Council last year in support of fireworks. He thanked Council Members for the firework-related decisions made last year.

Taylor Davis stated that he lives in Millcreek. He sent an email to the Council ahead of the City Council Meeting. He apologized if anyone felt blindsided by what happened, but that was not the intention. This is simply a group of parents who love the schools. The goal is not for the cities to choose to split the district, but to allow there to be an exploration into the possibility. Mr. Davis stressed the importance of a Feasibility Study. There is a desire to explore all options. The cost of a Feasibility Study is not prohibitive and some are willing to assist with the costs.

Laura Pinnock - 4919 Marilyn Drive. It has been almost 20 years since this issue was brought before the City and she was a part of a group discussing it back then. At that time, she had four children in public school. It has been a long time and she feels it makes sense to explore what a smaller school district might look like. The City can see whether or not it is feasible at this time. The average school district in the United States is 5,000 students, but there are 60,000 in the Granite School District. This has created certain limitations when it comes to the curriculum, teachers, and schools. The Council is being asked to allow a Feasibility Study and self-determination.

*Emily Low*e - *4295 Lynne Lane.* She is a mother of four children and has a unique perspective, because she taught in Memphis, Tennessee. One of the schools there was failing and was taken over by the State. It was one of six schools that was State-run and there was a Superintendent in her classroom multiple times that year. She had a close relationship with everyone on the Board there. Some schools are now thriving after being put into a smaller district. Smaller school districts can be beneficial to students and she believes this area is appropriate for a smaller school district.

*Betsy VanDenBerghe - 4206 Cumberland Rd.*_There have been a lot of changes in that time, but one of the best changes has been the increase in local control. She would like to see the community have that same kind of representation. As far as economies of scale, they tend to fade and not be as financially sound when there are more than 20,000 students. She has worked with the Granite School District as a parent since the early 2000s on several committees. Ms. VanDenBerghe has seen the difficulties associated with implementing a curriculum for 60,000 students. There is a lot of administrative work that needs to be done. She feels that a Millcreek and City of Holladay district could be the best district in the State.

Marissa Skinner - 1800 North Woodside Dr. She does not have an opinion about whether or not a school district split would be a good decision, but she does feel the residents should have the data to understand whether or not it is even a feasible option. She serves on an elementary school Community Council and has sat through a lot of discussions about school closures. As for what a Feasibility Study could do, she pointed out that this kind of study could examine whether it is possible to financially support a new district and could look into what benefits the teachers might gain.

Thayne Davis - 2007 E Lincoln Cir. He feels this should be a priority and asked that the City Council take this matter seriously during all discussions and deliberations.

Rianna Monstaff - 1801 E Spring Lane. She does not support the school district split, because there are not enough students to support this. If a new school district is created, it will likely cost a lot more than anticipated. She is concerned about opening a new school district and either seeing the property taxes increase or seeing money being taken away from public education.

Jason Brand shared an additional comment. He believes the school district split is worth exploring through a Feasibility Study. He does not feel there is a benefit to being in such a large district.

Rachel Thurgood - 1955 Longview Dr. The concerns that have been expressed by some residents would be addressed through the Feasibility Study. The study is the first step in this process. While she understands there are concerns about the decisions made by the Legislature, this is a priority issue that needs to be considered. The Feasibility Study would provide some additional clarity.

Brian Hall - 3400 E Brockbank Dr in Millcreek. He also attended the City Council Meeting in Millcreek and Mayor Jeff Silvestrini shared comments about the Millcreek Elementary School closure. Mr. Hall worries that if this study does not move ahead now, there will be a similar meeting held about elementary schools in the City of Holladay that have to be closed. He believes having more local representation will be better for all residents and asked that this be considered.

Lane O'Neil - 2277 E 4160 S. He pointed out that what is being proposed to the City Council is a Feasibility Study. This seems like an important issue to explore. He explained that exploring this study does not necessarily mean that a new district will be created. Taking time to explore all of the options through a Feasibility Study is something that can benefit all involved.

Sierra McQueen - 4148 S 2000 E. SHestressed the importance of this issue. She knows many others wanted to attend this meeting to express support for a Feasibility Study but were unable to attend. This is an issue that is being discussed often, as many parents are worried about the schools and the fabric of the neighborhoods if schools close in the future.

Blake Binkey is from Millcreek but lived with his mother-in-law in the City of Holladay for a time. He echoed some of the other comments that have been shared and explained that he is a product of a small school district. Where he grew up outside of Seattle, there were three elementary schools, one middle school, and one high school. He pointed out that people make sacrifices to live in the City of Holladay and Millcreek in order to put their children in wonderful public schools. This keeps the communities vibrant and the economies strong. There are many benefits associated with smaller school districts.

Brad Skinner - 1800 North Woodside Dr. He did not grow up in this area, but his wife did. He loves the community, the involvement, and the fact that people truly care about the City. He would love there to be a Feasibility Study so it is possible to make an informed choice.

Clara Neff stated that she and her husband both grew up in the area, moved away for eight years, and then came back. One of the reasons the family purchased a fixer-upper house was because there was a love of the neighborhood and the nearby schools. A lot of sacrifices have been made for her family to live in the area, so it would be devastating to see a change happen with the schools.

David Stephenson shared an additional comment with the City Council. He believes it is always better to have more information when making a decision. Mr. Stephenson thinks a smaller and more responsive district would be beneficial, but it is not possible to discuss that until there has been a Feasibility Study conducted. He strongly encouraged the City Council to move forward with that.

Mayor Dahle noted that most commenters have either children or grandchildren who have attended the local public schools. Regardless of what happens, there is clearly a shared passion for the schools. He understands the emotions associated with potential school closures and expressed a willingness to remain engaged in this process. He reiterated that there could be a discussion scheduled with residents.

There were no further comments.

IV. *Consideration of Resolution 2025-05 - Adopting City Financial Policies.*

Council Member Fotheringham moved to APPROVE Resolution 2025-05 – Adopting City Financial Policies. Council Member Gray seconded the motion. Vote on Motion: Council Member Brewer-Aye; Council Member Durham-Aye; Council Member Fotheringham-Aye; Council Member Quinn-Aye; Council Member Gray-Aye; Mayor Dahle-Aye. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Council.

V. *Consideration of Resolution 2025-06 - Approving an Interlocal Agreement with Salt Lake County for Election Services.*

Council Member Durham moved to APPROVE Resolution 2025-06 – Approving an Interlocal Agreement with Salt Lake County for Election Services. Council Member Quinn seconded the motion. Vote on Motion: Council Member Brewer-Aye; Council Member Durham-Aye; Council Member Fotheringham-Aye; Council Member Quinn-Aye; Council Member Gray-Aye; Mayor Dahle-Aye. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Council.

VI. *Consideration of Resolution 2025-07 - Approving an Interlocal Agreement with Salt Lake County for Traffic Signal Installation (1925 East Murray Holladay Road).*

Council Member Quinn moved to APPROVE Resolution 2025-07 – Approving an Interlocal Agreement with Salt Lake County for Traffic Signal Installation (1925 East Murray Holladay Road). Council Member Gray seconded the motion. Vote on Motion: Council Member Brewer-Aye; Council Member Durham-Aye; Council Member Fotheringham-Aye; Council Member Quinn-Aye; Council Member Gray-Aye; Mayor Dahle-Aye. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Council.

VII. *Consideration of Resolution 2025-08 - Approving an Interlocal Agreement with Salt Lake County for Reimbursement of 2025 TRCC Grant Funds (City Hall Auditorium Renovation).*

Council Member Fotheringham moved to APPROVE Resolution 2025-08 – Approving an Interlocal Agreement with Salt Lake County for Reimbursement of 2025 TRCC Grant Funds (City Hall Auditorium Renovation). Council Member Brewer seconded the motion. Vote on Motion: Council Member Brewer-Aye; Council Member Durham-Aye; Council Member Fotheringham-Aye; Council Member Quinn-Aye; Council Member Gray-Aye; Mayor Dahle-Aye. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Council.

VIII. ***Consent Agenda***

a. Approval of Minutes – March 6 and 20, 2025.

Council Member Gray moved to APPROVE the Consent Agenda. Council Member Fotheringham seconded the motion. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Council.

IX. ***City Manager Report - Gina.***

Ms. Chamness shared updates with the Council. She reported that The Great Utah ShakeOut took place earlier. There was an exercise held in City Hall to see what would happen if there was a power outage with trees knocked down and damage done to the roof. Due to that exercise, there is now a better understanding of the vulnerabilities, which includes contacting City Staff.

Ms. Chamness reported that there are a number of grant applications that will be made over the next little while. The first is a reapplication for the earmark that the City is targeted to receive in the current year's Federal Budget. She reminded Council Members that in lieu of adopting a budget, the Federal government adopted a continuing resolution that will continue through September 30. The earmark, which is part of the Community Project Fund, was put on hold. The City will reapply for that and should have an idea of whether or not that will be funded by July 2025. Ms. Chamness reported that the application was for $2 million last year, but the committees whittled that amount down to $1.65 million. The City will reapply for $2 million.

The City will be applying for a program that is funded through the Utah Department of Transportation ("UDOT") through the Transportation Alternatives Program ("TAP") for a sidewalk fill-in project on the south side of 5600 South from Highland Drive to Van Winke. There are still some engineering cost estimates being worked through for that.

There will be an application submitted through the UDOT Safe Sidewalks Program for the second phase of a sidewalk fill-in project on the north side of 4500 South. That amount is still in development, with a maximum of $200,000 for the application. Another sidewalk fill-in project is on the west side of 2000 East from Lincoln Lane to 3900 South. That deadline is a little further out on May 23, 2025, and the City is looking at a project between $200,000 and $300,000. Ms. Chamness noted that the City Council will be updated with a final number before the application is submitted.

The City Council approved an agreement with Salt Lake County for TRCC funding for a study for the auditorium. Ms. Chamness reported that the City will apply by June 16, 2025. The costs are to be determined. Ms. Chamness noted that there is a desire to submit a Corridor Preservation Program request. Willing sellers are needed for a project that has been discussed previously. She will share updates about that in the future. Ms. Chamness asked that Council Member concerns about the applications be expressed. Council Member Brewer does not have concerns about the

applications but asked about the 4500 South project mentioned. Ms. Chamness explained that it is an unusual situation because 4500 South is a State road. The owner of that road would generally provide the improvements, but in this case, UDOT has asked the City to apply and provide a match.

X. *Council Reports and District Issues.*

Council Member Gray thanked the Fire Department because there has been an increased need for those services in District 5. She expressed appreciation for the protection of businesses and homes.

Council Member Quinn attended the Howard R. Driggs Elementary School and Churchill Junior High School Community Council Meetings. This is the time of year when schools finalize how certain funds will be spent. She expressed appreciation for parents, teachers, and administrators.

Council Member Fotheringham reported that the Unified Fire Authority ("UFA") Finance Committee met recently. The preliminary budget has been reviewed and it looks like the member fee increase for the City will be in the 4.2% range. The City of Holladay percentage was a little bit higher than some of the other member cities because there are some of the costs allocated based on call volumes. He noted that most of the call volumes in the City of Holladay are medical-related as opposed to fire-related.

Council Member Matt Durham shared information about the Tree Committee. On April 25, 2025, there will be a tree planting in connection with Arbor Day. It will take place at Cottonwood Elementary School and he will attend the event. On May 17, 2025, the Tree Giveaway will take place. Registration and sign-up for that event is ongoing. There has been a good response to that so far. Council Member Durham discussed the Happy Healthy Holladay Coalition. There were some responses in connection to the City Survey about public health needs. Based on that feedback, residents were most concerned about mental health and air quality. The Happy Healthy Holladay Coalition will think about ways to address those issues moving forward. Work is almost done formulating the core working group for key leaders in the community, which will be beneficial.

Council Member Brewer reported that the Historical Commission held their last meeting during spring break, so he was unable to attend. The next speaker will be Martha Bradley-Evans on May 12, 2025. Council Member Brewer noted that May is Preservation Month. As for the South Salt Lake Valley Mosquito Abatement District, it looks like there will be a Truth in Taxation process.

Mayor Dahle reported that he and Economic Development and Housing Manager, Ann Francis Garcia, met with someone from Kiln, an upscale shared office space business. It is taking 60,000 square feet in the Holladay Hills site. It will be on half of the second floor and half of the third floor. There was a meeting with the developers to review certain matters and there is excitement about some of the tenants. For instance, there was a Business License application submitted by Trader Joe's. Mayor Dahle stated that a lot is happening in that area and it will be beneficial to the community.

XI. *Recess City Council in a Work Meeting.*

Council Member Fotheringham moved to ADJOURN the City Council Meeting and RECONVENE in a Work Meeting. Council Member Brewer seconded the motion. The motion passed with unanimous consent. The City Council convened in a work meeting at 7:15 pm.

a. **Discussion on Fireworks Ordinance.**

The Council needs to vote on what will be submitted to the County for the restrictions. Council Members reviewed the information including the previous restrictions. Discussions were had about different locations shown on the map and the Spring Creek area. City Recorder, Stephanie Carlson explained that descriptions are sent to the Unified Fire Authority ("UFA") for the mapping.

Mayor Dahle does not believe there is an issue with the map from last year in terms of the restricted areas. The question is whether there is a desire to have restrictions east of 1300 East based on the conditions. Essentially, the City Council needs to determine whether the current restrictions should remain or if the map should become more restrictive. Ms. Chamness noted that the Fire Marshal does not recommend making more of the City available for fireworks. Once an area is open for fireworks, it is harder to move that back in the future. Some information was shared about what the restrictions look like in cities like Cottonwood Heights and Millcreek.

Council Members discussed penalties for fireworks in restricted areas and past enforcement measures. Chief Hoyal reported that there is a $1,000 fine for fireworks penalties. There are normally officers out on holidays to patrol and enforce. Council Member Brewer asked about the number of citations. Chief Hoyal clarified that there are not usually a lot issued. There are typically a couple of fireworks citations issued per year. The difficulty is that if a call is received, the use of fireworks is often over before an officer arrives on the scene. Council Member Brewer acknowledged that there is a heightened fear due to the severity of the fires that happened in California. He stressed the importance of enforcement, as the use of fireworks in a restricted area is a safety issue that can impact everyone in the community. He feels citations should be issued. Chief Hoyal shared information about enforcement efforts and the main areas of focus.

b. **Code Update – Review of Title 2.**

There was additional discussions about the proposed language. 2.11.280: Signing Authority is as follows:

- The City Council may authorize the Manager to sign any agreement, purchase order, obligation, form, or other document. In addition, the Manager has authority to sign all documents necessary to allow the City to make minimal purchases and small purchases, as defined in this chapter, provided that funds have been previously appropriated by the City Council. When a specific appropriation has been made by the City Council, or for any contract or written obligations less than $100,000, the Manager may sign.

Mr. Blakesley explained that based on that language, the Manager could approve up to that amount within the budget parameters. If it is a contract or purchase above that amount, then it would come to the City Council. There is a requirement that a threshold must be established, but there is no requirement for what that threshold must be. Cities will choose different thresholds based on the size of the city. Ms. Chamness shared some clarifications about the proposed code language.

Additional discussions were had about the 2.11.280 language. Council Member Brewer thought more specificity would be beneficial. He noted it might make sense for the Mayor to sign as well. Council Member Fotheringham pointed out that this language simply relates to signing authority.

c. **Budget Discussion.**

- **Central Wasatch Commission ("CWC").**

Mayor Dahle asked if the Council Members took time to look at the CWC website. Council Member Fotheringham reported that he reviewed the website and looked at the participating member jurisdictions. Mayor Dahle believes the CWC is essentially a lobbying organization for municipalities that are impacted by the canyons: Big Cottonwood Canyon, Little Cottonwood Canyon, and Millcreek Canyon. The CWC started with the Mountain Accord process. Holladay is not currently part of the CWC, but there was a recent discussion with the Executive Director, Lindsey Nielsen, and there is a desire to see Holladay become a member jurisdiction of the CWC. He added that the CWC is involved in conversations about long-term transportation challenges.

Mayor Dahle pointed out that there is a budget impact associated with becoming a member jurisdiction. He asked if there is anyone on the City Council who is passionate about this work and would be willing to serve on the CWC Board to represent Holladay. Council Member Gray expressed an interest in the work of the organization. Mayor Dahle believes the budget impact would be $25,000. Council Members expressed support for a presentation from the CWC about the organization. Council Member Gray pointed out that Holladay does not border any of the canyons directly, so she wants to better understand how the CWC envisions Holladay participation. Mayor Dahle believes the role of the Holladay representative would be to contribute to the CWC Board. There would be involvement in an organization that focuses on issues that impact the canyons

- **Sales Tax Assumptions.**

Ms. Chamness noted that last year at this time, there was some uncertainty about what the sales tax would look like. It has been fairly flat for about six quarters. As a result, what has been built into the budget is a continuation of that flat trend. There is a lot of uncertainty in all markets right now. Council Member Fotheringham stated that he would not want the assumptions to be higher than shown, because the projections for a recession continue to increase. He is grateful there are healthy fund balances.

The Preliminary Revenue information was shared. Ms. Chamness reported that there is an increase projected in General Fund revenue of $501,675. Mayor Dahle asked about the Bailiff line item and wondered whether that is increasing. Ms. Chamness explained there is court three and a half days per week. However, it is anticipated that the schedule will need to be increased. Those expenses will be shared with Millcreek and Cottonwood Heights.

There is a projected increase for UFA of $126,242 and there is $406,384 listed for police services. Mayor Dahle shared comments about the Capital Projects Fund. He is curious to see that budget and how much will be invested in the roads. During the retreat, it was determined that there is a desire to invest between $800,000 or $900,000 per year in roads. Ms. Chamness believes that the Finance Director has prepared a budget with $800,000 for roads. As for the personnel-related changes, there is the 3% cost of living adjustment ("COLA").

.

Ms. Chamness reported that there are several items listed for Council Member discussion. Most of the items listed came out of the Retreat. Something identified as a goal in the retreat had to do with additional tree lighting. Mayor Dahle pointed out that the estimate is only for the infrastructure and there would likely be additional costs as well. He is looking at this as an economic development project that will attract people to the village. However, he acknowledged that the one-time cost is high and there are also ongoing costs each year to take into account. Council Member Fotheringham believes what residents value about the City of Holladay is the small-town feel. This kind of enhancement makes sense. It could be planned out over the long term rather than handled in a single year. Discussions were had about the areas where additional tree lighting has been contemplated.

Ms. Chamness discussed the possibility of metal banners. These would be more significant than the other banner style and would be in place for much of the year. There is a placeholder of $30,000 listed. Council Member Brewer requested some example images. Council Member Fotheringham wanted to know if these would be concentrated in the village or spread out throughout the City. It was noted that these would be concentrated.

The Council next discussed the idea of a professionally produced video about Holladay. Mayor Dahle reported that in different cities, there are videos created that highlight the history of the city, parks, and economic development areas. Council Member Gray wondered whether a video about Holladay would bring in new businesses. Mayor Dahle believes the cities that currently have these kinds of videos are using them to attract businesses to the area. Holladay does not have that type of commercial base. Based on the discussions, he is not certain that a video makes sense at this time, but it might be something for the Council to revisit in the future.

d. **Calendar.**

- ***Council Meetings – May 1, 8, and 15, June 5 and 12.***

The calendar items were reviewed during the Briefing Session.

e. **Other Business.**

There was no additional business discussed.

XII. ***Closed Session Pursuant to Utah Code Section 52-4-204 and 205.***

Council Member Gray moved to go into Closed Session Pursuant to Utah Code Section 52-4-204 and 205. Council Member Fotheringham seconded the motion. Vote on Motion: Council Member Gray-Aye; Council Member Brewer-Aye; Council Member Durham-Aye; Council Member Fotheringham-Aye; Council Member Quinn-Aye; Mayor Dahle-Aye. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Council.

The Council convened in a closed session at 7:15 p.m. Those in attendance in the Closed Session included Council Members Durham, Fotheringham, Quinn, Gray, Brewer, and Mayor Dahle. Others present included Gina Chamness, Jayme Blakesley and Stephanie Carlson.

The minutes of the Closed Session were taken and are on file as a Protected Record

Council Member Fotheringham moved to adjourn the Closed Session. Council Member Quinn seconded the motion. The Council roll call vote was as follows: Council Members Durham, Fotheringham, Quinn, Gray, Brewer and Mayor Dahle in favor. The motion to go out of closed session at 8:39 p.m. passed with a unanimous vote

XIII. ***Adjourn.***

Council Member Fotheringham moved to ADJOURN. Council Member Durham seconded the motion. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Council.

The City Council Meeting adjourned at approximately 8:40 p.m.

I hereby certify that the foregoing represents a true, accurate, and complete record of the Holladay City Council Meeting held Thursday, April 17, 2025.

_____ _____

Stephanie N. Carlson, MMC
Holladay City Recorder

Robert Dahle, Mayor

Minutes approved: **June 5, 2025**